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CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 46: Leadership Skills

Part II

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Leadership Skills

“A leader is a forceful and dynamic personality who really leads from the front; an architect and implementer of strategy; a mediator in conflict situations; an integrator who assures the climate of the organization; a person able to motivate, subordinate and who, by persuasion, compulsion or example to others, succeeds in getting others to follow the leader’s wishes.”

– Sorenson & Epps



Leadership and Change

“The only person who likes change is a baby with a wet diaper.”

-Mark Twain

The **reasons** behind an imperative **need for a meaningful and sustainable change** in an organization are:

- To overcome the challenges faced by the organization in terms of growth or decline
- The changing global markets and trends or technologies
- The need for innovation and development
- The pressure of competing with the market rivals

Leader's role in change management:

- To envision a positive change
- To enable the followers to cope up with the confusion, stress, chaos and insecurities associated with the change during implementation of the change
- To emphasize upon the opportunities, growth, excitement and adventure of the new vision
- To utilize the change to benefit the growth and development of the organization

“The difficulty lies not so much in developing new ideas as in escaping from the old ones.”

- John Maynard Keynes

Leadership and Change: The 8 - Step Model

John P. Kotter, an influential author on organizational change management (*Leading Change*, 1995) describes an **eight – step model** for understanding, leading and implementing changes in an organization:

1. Increase Urgency towards the necessity of the change



2. Build the guiding team comprising right mix of skills and responsibilities



3. Create a compelling vision and a simple strategy



4. Communicate for buy-in by appealing to people's needs

5. Empower Action by eliminating setbacks and rewarding progress



6. Create short-term wins and aim for achievable targets



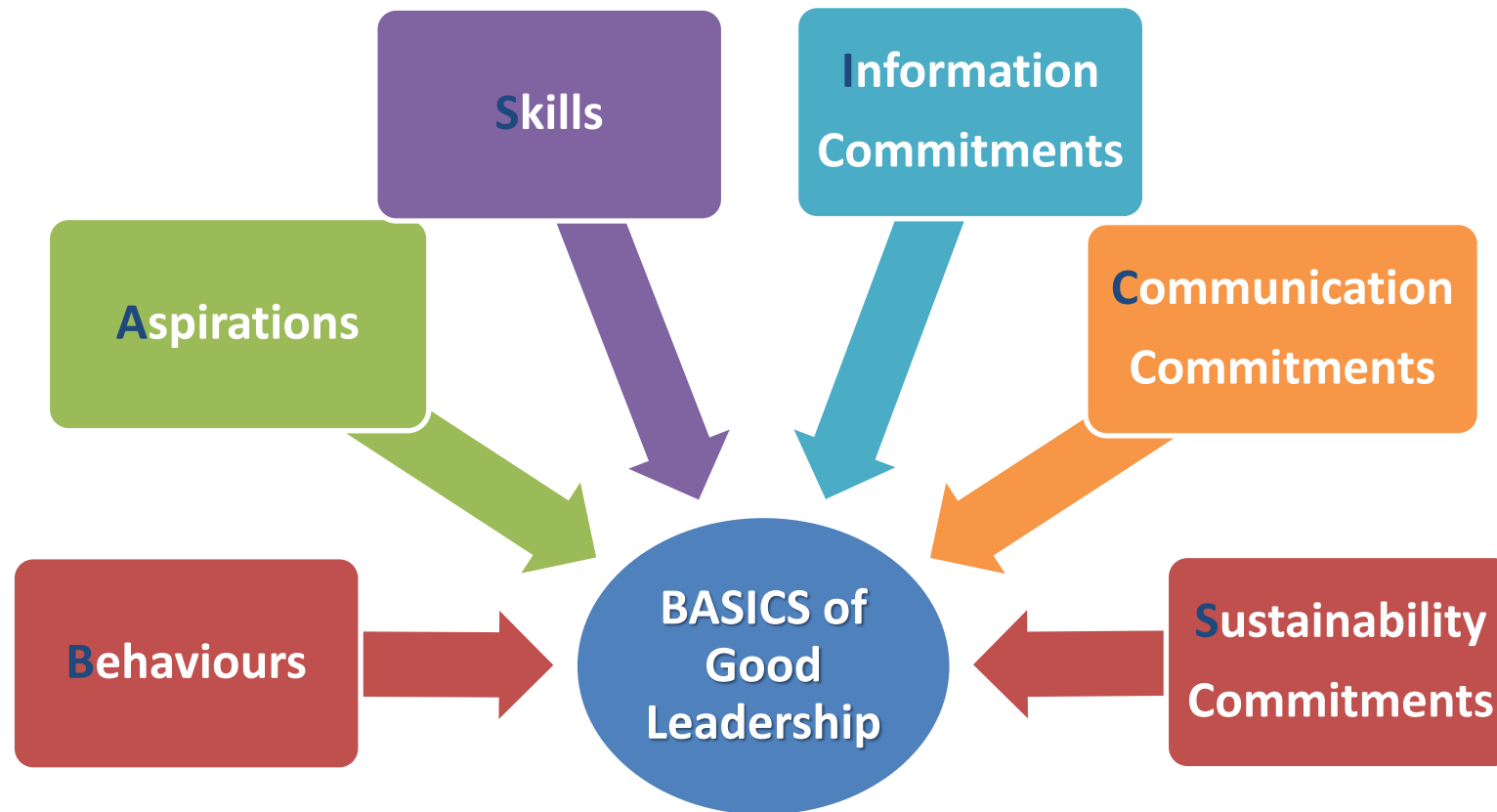
7. Don't let up – Lead with determination and persistence



8. Make change stick by weaving it into organization's culture

Leadership Skills: The BASICS Model

Darryl Plecas, Colette Squires and Len Garis in their book '*The Essentials of Leadership in Government*' outline the **BASICS model**, defining the basic attributes of good leadership as follows:



The BASICS Model: Behavioural Attributes

The test of good leadership is to do the right thing, at the right time, for the right reason, in the right way. The **BASICS model** recommends the following behaviours for good leadership:

- ☐ **Visionary:** Possess a sense of vision – a compelling vision of future and strategic opportunities. Visualize the path to bring the vision to life.
- ☐ **Collaborative:** Motivate people to combine their talents, efforts, insights and enthusiasm to work together. Healthy collaboration upholds shared commitments and stimulates effective action.
- ☐ **Innovative:** Encourage innovative skills and creativity to stimulate exploratory solutions to problems.
- ☐ **Courageous:** Be bold pioneers to undertake risks, challenge conventions and experiment thinking out-of-the box to find better ways of doing things.
- ☐ **Empathetic:** Lead with compassion, empathy, respect and concern for the well-being and success of subordinates and colleagues.

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Positive Attitude

Strong leadership requires optimism and commitment to pursue the vision

Trustworthiness

"Leaders can no longer trust in power; instead, they rely on the power of trust."
- Charles Green

Integrity

It involves keeping one's commitments, consistency of behaviour & accepting the responsibility of one's behaviour

"Anyone can steer the ship, but it takes a leader to chart the course." – John C. Maxwell

Confidence

- Developed by self-competence
- Optimistic belief in one's capabilities
- Boldness to undertake challenging tasks

Focus and Clarity

- Focus attention, energy & resources on priorities
- Provide clarity of direction and workflow & resolve ambiguities

Discipline

- Consistent self-discipline as well as organizational discipline
- Well-organized, a sense of self-control, determination and will-power

The BASICS Model: Aspirational Attributes

Excellence – Strive towards committing excellent experience at personal and organizational level

Result-oriented – Strategize your actions towards achieving high productivity

Ethical & Principled – Demonstrate an upright moral compass through your dealings to create an ethical, value-based culture

Realist Approach – Prefer thoughtful, reasonable scepticism over fanciful, unrealistic optimism

Scrupulous opportunist – Leverage situations of crisis into advantageous moments ; negotiate conflicts to a win-win agreement

Motivational – Inspire the followers, infuse enthusiasm and empower them to accomplish their goals

ASPIRATION

The BASICS Model: Skill Attributes

1. Communicative Skill: *“Leadership is a dialogue, not a monologue.”*

– James M. Kouzes and Barry Z. Posner (*The Leadership Challenge*)

- ❖ Effective, positive and transparent communication is crucial to build trust in leadership. Competent communication involves – **carefully thought content** in **appropriate quantity** conveyed via **suitable modes/means** in a **two-way process** involving the sender and the receiver, leading up to **achieving the objectives** of the conversation.

2. Skill of Effective Listening: *“We have been given two ears and but a single mouth, in order that we may hear more and talk less.”* – Zeno of Citrium

Four basic types of listening are –

- Inactive Listening** – When words go only in one ear.
- Selective Listening** – When one filters the message and chooses to hear only when one wants to.
- Active Listening** – When one takes into consideration the complete message, intent and non-verbal communication of the speaker.
- Reflective Listening** – The deepest and most involved form of listening; emphasizes emotional aspects of communication; provides feedback to the speaker.

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3. **Conflict Resolution Skill:** Since diversity and differences are an inevitable dimension of all human interactions, the skill to effectively resolve conflicting situations become crucial to leadership.

“Peace is not the absence of conflict, it is the ability to handle conflict by peaceful means.”

– Ronald Reagan

Tips to Manage Conflict positively:

- ☐ **Pick your battles:** Be mindful to decide whether the issue of conflict is worth your time and energy.
- ☐ **Prioritise conflict resolution** over the issue of winning or being right.
- ☐ **Separate the problem from the person** – attack the issues, do not be in dispute with the person.
- ☐ **Listen** to get informed as well as to connect to other person's position.
- ☐ **Be open to ideas** and explore solutions together.
- ☐ If consensus seems unattainable, **choose to agree to disagree**, disengage and move on.

Conflict Communication Strategies

Win-Win	Win-Lose/Lose-lose
Clarifying questions	Accusations
Alternative solutions	Complaints
Statement of fact	Exaggeration
Logic	Aggression
Humour	Sarcasm
Deliberated responses	Hasty replies
Issues	Personalities
Diplomacy	Insults

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Negotiation Skill

- Resolve conflict through collaborative negotiation
- Focus on building harmonious interpersonal relationships

Problem-solving Skill

- “**Leadership is solving problems.**” – **Colin Powell**
- Anticipate problems; mould obstacles into opportunities

Resource and Finance Management Skill

- Adopt sound financial planning and management of budgets
- Adhere to transparency ethics regarding the use of funds and assets

Strategic Thinking

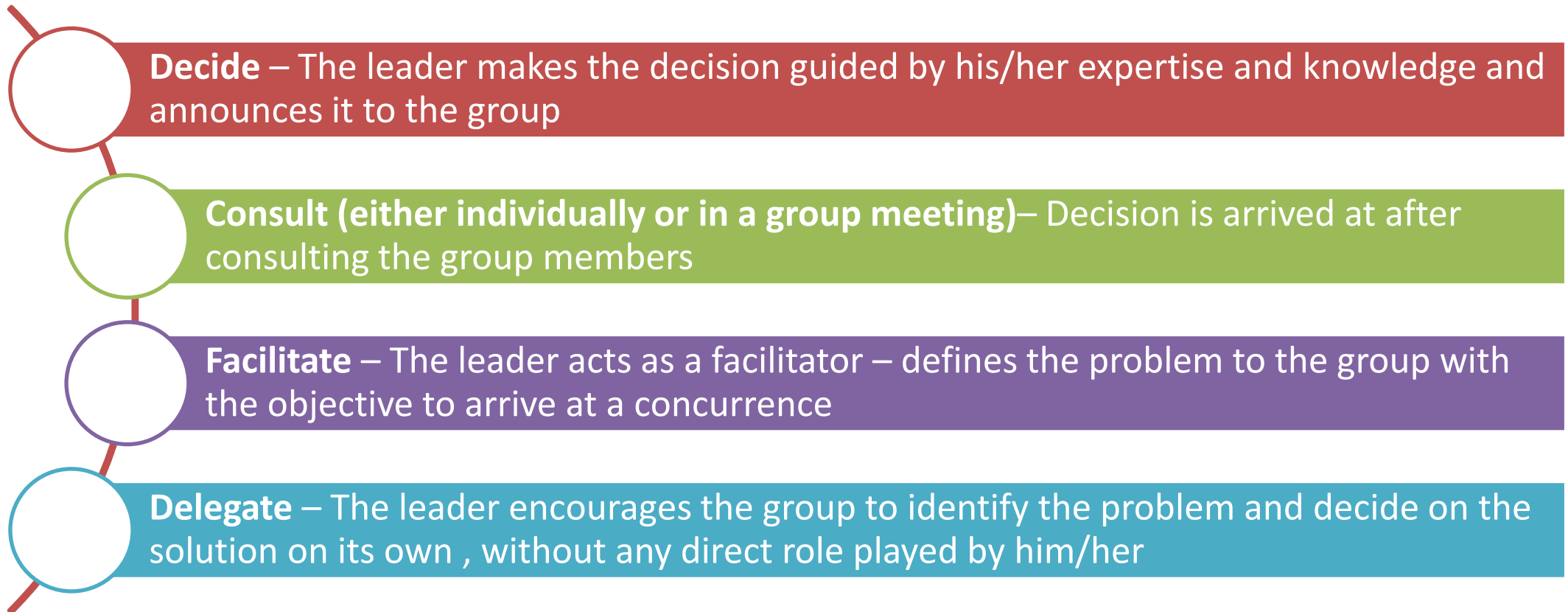
- Personal organization, effective time management, scheduling of tasks, managing e-mails, note-taking

Organizational Skill

- “**Effective leaders engage in strategic thinking, strategic actions, and strategic influencing.**” – (Hughes and Beatty, 2005)

The BASICS Model: Skill Attributes (contd.)

- ❑ **Decision Making Skill** – *“Nothing is more difficult, and therefore more precious, than to be able to decide.”* – Napoléon I
- ❑ The four leadership approaches to Decision-making are as follows:



The BASICS Model: Information Commitments

- ❑ The information commitments of a good leader has the following four dimensions:

Internal

- Be informed of one's weaknesses
- Receive feedback with a healthy spirit
- Strive towards lifelong learning and personal growth

Interpersonal

- Be sensitive to the concerns, hopes, needs and ambitions of colleagues, subordinates and external stakeholders as well

Operational

- Know the goal of the organization
- Work with a well-informed vision
- Ensure commitment to an evidence-informed approach in decision making

External

- Keep yourself updated with the recent trends, developments and events – globally, nationally and locally

The BASICS Model: Communication Commitments

Communicating gratitude and appreciation to team members

Adopt a grateful attitude
Acknowledge the efforts of the subordinates

Transparent Communication

Build trust amongst your followers through a positive, transparent and honest communication

Easy and accessible communication

Ensure a smooth, approachable and direct channel of communication

Active Listening

Welcome other's ideas and perspectives through consultation

Information Sharing

Be mindful about the information to be shared with the stakeholders; and of those that ought to be withheld

The BASICS Model: Sustainability Commitments

“A sustainable leader is someone who inspires and supports action towards a better world.”
– Visser & Courtice

Environmental Responsibility

- Manage material resources taking care of the effect of one's actions on the environment

Workplace Health and Wellness

- Ensure health and safety of the employees
- Build a wellness culture at the workplace



Empowering People

- Show commitment towards training, mentoring and supporting the team members towards their personal growth and development

Culture of Respect and Dignity

- ✓ Make certain that the subordinates feel valued, respected and listened to

The four manifestations of leadership

Centred Leader

The leader who is centred and grounded in the here and now, demonstrates authenticity and integrity and has a clear sense of purpose.

Relationship Leader

The leader who fosters relationships, creates community, and cultivates collaboration to release the potential of individuals and groups.

Results Leader

The leader who produces results, gets things done, and sustains commitment throughout a process of initiation, delivery and completion.

Visionary Leader

The leader who envisions possibilities, applies creative foresight to generate options and be a pioneer, and evokes an enthusiastic following through the inspirational communication of a vision.



“A leader is one who sees more than others see, who sees farther than others see and who sees before others do.” – Leroy Eims

“Leadership is the capacity to translate vision into reality.” – Warren Bennis

Boss Leadership Versus Enabler Leadership

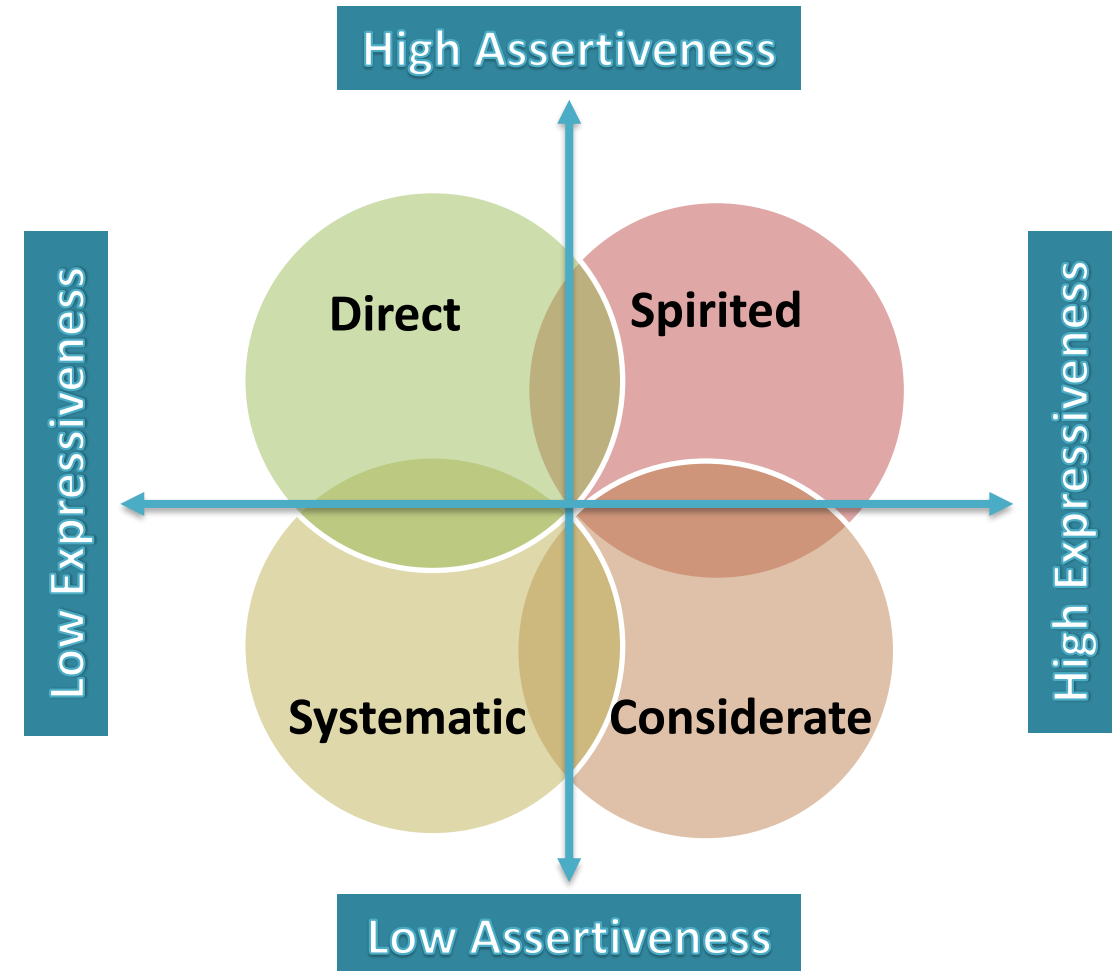
Boss Leadership	Enabler Leadership
✓ Goal is to be served	○ Goal is to help others grow to their fullest potential
✓ Co-workers are treated as subordinates	○ Co-workers are treated as team members
✓ Uses power and authority to influence	○ Influences by inspiring respect and admiration from followers
✓ Accountable only to superiors	○ Accountable to the entire team/organization
✓ Gives responsibility	○ Feels responsible
✓ Inspires fear	○ Generates enthusiasm
✓ Shuns constructive criticism; takes the credit for results	○ Welcomes input and feedback; ○ Shares the credit for results



Personality Matrix and Leadership Ability

Dr. Eileen Russo's model for studying human behaviour uses two dimensions – expressiveness and assertiveness – that results into **four personality quadrants**:

- ❑ Leaders of a **Direct Personality Style** are:
 - Driven to succeed and are competitive
 - Assertive and decisive
- ❑ Leaders of a **Spirited Personality Style** are:
 - Passionate, enthusiastic and visionary
 - Multi-taskers; willing to take risks
- ❑ Leaders of a **Systematic Personality Style** are:
 - Consistent, rational, precise and disciplined
 - Business-oriented and driven by logic
- ❑ Leaders of a **Considerate Personality Style** are:
 - Emotional and people-pleasers
 - Seek to foster relationships on personal level



Role of Leader in the Development of a Team

Stage	Characteristics	Leader's Role
Forming	Members disclose information about themselves in the polite but tentative interactions. They explore the purposes of the group and gather information about each other's interests, skills and personal tendencies.	✓ Establish clear objectives ✓ Assign defining roles ✓ State team purpose
Storming	Disagreements about procedures and purposes surface, so criticism and conflict increase. Much of the conflict stems from the challenges between members who are seeking to increase their status and control the group.	✓ Establish procedure and policies ✓ Identify and address conflicts
Norming	Once the group agrees on its goal, procedures, leadership, norms and roles, social relationships develop that increase the group's stability and cohesiveness.	✓ Encourage team-building ✓ Motivate team members towards positive contribution
Performing	The group focuses its energies and attention on its goals, displaying higher rates of task orientation, decision making and problem solving.	✓ Delegate responsibility to team members
Adjourning	The group prepares to disband by completing its tasks, reduces levels of dependency among members, and dealing with any unresolved issues.	✓ Celebrate success of team ✓ Solicit lessons learned

Bruce Tuckman's Model: "Developmental Sequence in small Group". *Psychological Bulletin*, 63, 384-399 (1965)

Laws of Leadership by John C. Maxwell

The Law of Influence

The true measure of leadership is influence

The Law of Process

Leadership develops daily, not in a day

The Law of Sacrifice

A leader must give up to go up

The Law of Solid Ground

Trust is the foundation of leadership

The Law of Magnetism

Who you are is who you attract

The Law of Connection

Leaders touch a heart, before they ask for a hand

The Law of Buy-in

People buy into the leader, then the vision

Leadership in a New Age

- ❖ Organizational Culture
- ❖ People
- ❖ Systems
- ❖ Information
- ❖ Style
- ❖ Job Design

“If the 1980s were about quality, and the 1990s were about reengineering, then the 2000s will be about velocity, about how quickly business itself will be transacted.”

-Bill Gates

**A good leader takes
a little more than his
share of the blame,
a little less than his
share of the credit.**

- Arnold H. Glasgow

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Thank You

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